

POCKET GUIDE

50 Everyday Brazilian Expressions

The phrases Brazilians really use — with pronunciation
tips and examples for each one.

PORTUGUÊS DO BRASIL

How to use this guide

These are the expressions you'll actually hear in everyday Brazil — on the street, at a bar, in a text message, at work. Textbooks rarely teach them, but Brazilians use them constantly. Learn a handful and you'll sound far more natural.

Each entry gives you the expression, what it really means, a quick pronunciation tip written for English speakers, and an example so you can see it in action.

A NOTE ON PRONUNCIATION

- Pronunciation is written the way it *sounds*, not in phonetic symbols — read it out loud like English.
- **Stressed syllables are shown in CAPITALS.**
- Brazilian Portuguese turns many **d** and **t** sounds before "i"/"e" into "j" and "ch" — e.g. *dia* sounds like "JEE-ah".
- Final **-m** and many vowels are nasal (through the nose); the "~" hints at that.
- Regional accents vary — these tips lean on the widely-understood Southeast/São Paulo–Rio style.

The Expressions

GREETINGS & SMALL TALK

1 E aí? — *What's up? / Hey!*

Say it: "ee-AH-ee"

E aí, tudo bem? — Hey, everything good?

2 Tudo bem? / Tudo bom? — *All good? (hello + how are you)*

Say it: "TOO-doo BENG" / "TOO-doo BONG"

— **Tudo bem?** — **Tudo!** — "All good?" "All good!" (answer with the same word)

3 Beleza? — *Cool? / All right? (lit. "beauty")*

Say it: "beh-LEH-zah"

— **Beleza?** — **Beleza!** — "You good?" "All good!"

4 Fala sério! — *No way! / You're kidding!*

Say it: "FAH-lah SEH-ryoo"

Ganhou na loteria? Fala sério! — You won the lottery? No way!

5 Oi, sumido! — *Hey stranger! (to someone you haven't seen)*

Say it: "oy soo-MEE-doo"

Oi, sumido! Quanto tempo! — Hey stranger! Long time!

REACTIONS & FEELINGS

6 **Nossa!** — *Wow! / Oh my! (all-purpose surprise)*

Say it: "NOH-sah"

Nossa, que calor! — Wow, it's so hot!

7 **Que legal!** — *How cool! / That's great!*

Say it: "kee leh-GAOW"

Vai viajar? Que legal! — You're travelling? How cool!

8 **Que saco!** — *What a pain! / How annoying!*

Say it: "kee SAH-koo"

Chuva de novo? Que saco! — Rain again? What a pain!

9 **Caramba!** — *Wow! / Damn! (mild, safe for all)*

Say it: "kah-RANG-bah"

Caramba, que susto! — Wow, what a fright!

10 **Que chato!** — *How annoying / What a bummer*

Say it: "kee SHAH-too"

Cancelaram? Que chato. — They cancelled? What a bummer.

11 **Aff!** — *Ugh! (exasperation / disgust)*

Say it: "AHF"

Aff, esqueci a chave. — Ugh, I forgot the key.

12 **Que fofo!** — *How cute! / How sweet!*

Say it: "kee FOH-foo"

Olha o cachorrinho, que fofo! — Look at the puppy, how cute!

AGREEING, CONFIRMING & FILLER

13 Tá bom / Tá — *OK / All right (shortened "está")*

Say it: "tah BONG" / "tah"

— **Me liga depois. — Tá!** — "Call me later." "OK!"

14 Com certeza — *For sure / Definitely*

Say it: "kong ser-TEH-zah"

Vai à festa? Com certeza! — Going to the party? For sure!

15 Claro! — *Of course!*

Say it: "KLAH-roo"

Claro que sim! — Of course, yes!

16 Né? — *Right? / Isn't it? (tag on everything)*

Say it: "neh" (nasal)

Tá caro, né? — It's expensive, right?

17 Tipo assim — *Like / Kind of (filler)*

Say it: "TEE-poo ah-SEENG"

Foi tipo assim, do nada. — It was, like, out of nowhere.

18 Sei lá — *I dunno / Who knows*

Say it: "say LAH"

Por que ele fez isso? Sei lá. — Why did he do that? I dunno.

19 Pois é — *Yeah / Exactly / That's how it is*

Say it: "poyz EH"

— **A vida tá difícil. — Pois é...** — "Life's hard." "Yeah, tell me about it..."

GETTING THINGS DONE

20 Vamos nessa! — *Let's go! / Let's do this!*

Say it: "VAH-moos NEH-sah"

Tá pronto? Vamos nessa! — Ready? Let's go!

21 Bora! — *Come on / Let's go (short for "embora")*

Say it: "BOH-rah"

Bora almoçar? — Shall we go grab lunch?

22 Deixa comigo — *Leave it to me / I've got it*

Say it: "DAY-shah koo-MEE-goo"

Relaxa, deixa comigo. — Relax, leave it to me.

23 Dar um jeito — *To sort it out / find a way*

Say it: "dar oong JAY-too"

Calma, a gente dá um jeito. — Calm down, we'll sort it out.

24 Já já — *In a sec / very soon*

Say it: "zhah ZHAH"

Já já eu chego. — I'll be there in a sec.

25 Daqui a pouco — *In a little while*

Say it: "dah-KEE ah POH-koo"

Falo com você daqui a pouco. — I'll talk to you in a bit.

26 Vale a pena — *It's worth it*

Say it: "VAH-lee ah PEH-nah"

O filme vale a pena. — The movie is worth it.

SLANG & DESCRIBING PEOPLE

27 Cara — *Dude / guy (also "man!" as filler)*

Say it: "KAH-rah"

Cara, que jogo incrível! — Dude, what an amazing game!

28 Mano / Mina — *Bro / girl (friend)*

Say it: "MAH-noo" / "MEE-nah"

E aí, mano, beleza? — Hey bro, all good?

29 Gente boa — *A good person / good people*

Say it: "ZHEN-chee BOH-ah"

O chefe é gente boa. — The boss is a good guy.

30 Chato — *Annoying / boring (person or thing)*

Say it: "SHAH-too"

Ele é meio chato. — He's kind of annoying.

31 Puxa-saco — *A suck-up / brown-noser*

Say it: "POO-shah SAH-koo"

Que puxa-saco do chefe! — What a suck-up to the boss!

32 Zoar / Zoando — *To joke around / mess with someone*

Say it: "zoh-AR" / "zoh-AN-doo"

Calma, tô só zoando! — Relax, I'm just messing with you!

33 Mó / Muito — *Really / super (intensifier)*

Say it: "maw" / "MOOEEN-too"

Foi mó legal! — It was super cool!

EVERYDAY SITUATIONS

34 Pois não? — *Can I help you? (polite, in shops)*

Say it: "poyz NAWNG"

— **Pois não?** — **Queria um café.** — "How can I help?" "I'd like a coffee."

35 Quanto é? / Quanto custa? — *How much is it?*

Say it: "KWAN-too EH" / "KWAN-too KOOS-tah"

Quanto é a passagem? — How much is the ticket?

36 Imagina! — *Don't mention it! (reply to "thanks")*

Say it: "ee-mah-ZHEE-nah"

— **Obrigado!** — **Imagina!** — "Thanks!" "Don't mention it!"

37 Pode deixar — *Sure / will do / consider it done*

Say it: "POH-jee day-SHAR"

— **Me avisa?** — **Pode deixar!** — "Let me know?" "Will do!"

38 Que isso! — *Come on! / No worries! (downplaying)*

Say it: "kee ee-soo"

Que isso, não precisa agradecer! — Come on, no need to thank me!

39 Tá ligado? — *You know? / You get me?*

Say it: "tah lee-GAH-doo"

É complicado, tá ligado? — It's complicated, you know?

40 Falou! / Valeu! — *Later! / Thanks! (casual goodbye)*

Say it: "fah-LOH" / "vah-LEW"

Então tá, falou! Valeu! — All right then, later! Thanks!

COLOURFUL IDIOMS

41 Nem vem! — *Don't even! / No way (playful)*

Say it: "neng VENG"

Nem vem que não tem! — Don't even try it! (a set rhyming phrase)

42 Pisar na bola — *To mess up / let someone down*

Say it: "pee-ZAR nah BOH-lah"

Ele pisou na bola comigo. — He let me down. (lit. "stepped on the ball")

43 Encher o saco — *To annoy / bug someone*

Say it: "en-SHER oo SAH-koo"

Para de encher o saco! — Stop bugging me!

44 Viajar na maionese — *To be totally off / talk nonsense*

Say it: "vee-ah-ZHAR nah my-oh-NEH-zee"

Você tá viajando na maionese. — You're way off. (lit. "travelling on the mayonnaise")

45 Cair a ficha — *For it to finally click / sink in*

Say it: "kah-EER ah FEE-shah"

Aí caiu a ficha. — Then it clicked. (lit. "the coin dropped")

46 Pagar mico — *To embarrass yourself*

Say it: "pah-GAR MEE-koo"

Paguei o maior mico ontem. — I totally embarrassed myself yesterday.

A FEW MORE YOU'LL HEAR DAILY

47 Tá tranquilo — *It's chill / no problem*

Say it: "tah tran-KEE-loo"

Não se preocupe, tá tranquilo. — Don't worry, it's all chill.

48 Que nem — *Just like / the same as*

Say it: "kee NENG"

Ela fala que nem a mãe. — She talks just like her mom.

49 Rolê — *An outing / hang / stroll*

Say it: "hoh-LEH"

Bora dar um rolê? — Wanna go hang out?

50 Saudade — *A deep longing / missing someone*

Say it: "sow-DAH-jee"

Que saudade de você! — I miss you so much! (Brazil's most famous word — it has no exact English translation.)
